

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Reed DeLabel

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Reed DeLabel

Doctoral Fellow in Art History

Reed reads every label aloud, including the exit sign. Reed is the youngest scholar attached to the exhibition and has been trying very hard to behave like this is normal.

- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supervises Reed's doctorate and rarely returns a clean draft.
- Gets informal guidance from **Claire O'Scuro** on exhibition labels and curatorial work.
- Checks dates and catalogue references for **Paige Turner**. Reed saves any article that includes a correction.
- **Anne E. Dote** coaches Reed through gallery tours. She keeps crossing footnotes out of the children's handouts.

ACTING TIPS

Eager, cerebral, anxious in a useful way, unexpectedly bold when the evidence is on your side.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Reed DeLabel. I am the graduate fellow. I know where the footnotes go and, more dangerously, where they are missing.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Reed DeLabel

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You found an archival document that contradicted the Star Bowl label. Grant told your department your fellowship could disappear if you pushed it.

Your other secret

You have not yet told Art that your discovery also undermines one sentence in his published research.

Conversations to start

- Ask Claire O'Scuro whether she is comfortable with the Star Bowl label.
- Ask Dr. Art E. Fact how a junior researcher should challenge a donor's version of history.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *Four legs and a metallic seat guard a secret from below.*
- 2 *Behind a cupboard's closed doors, one item has no domestic purpose.*
- 3 *Seek the sacred book with two testaments. Tonight its pages shelter evidence.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Reed DeLabel

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant threatened my fellowship over the routing document. It also undermines one sentence in Art's article, which I had not told him. Before the toast I locked myself in the research cage with my green index tabs, 6:39 to 6:45. I was preparing a correction that could lose me both funding and a supervisor.

IF MURDERER

The archive contradicts the label and one sentence in Art's research. Grant threatened my fellowship if I pursued it. I had not told Art about the second problem. I made copies at the outer desk because I did not trust Grant to leave the originals alone. My funding depended on someone whose story I was correcting.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Reed DeLabel

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Reed DeLabel

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I examined the bowl early and then worked through the routing file. The reference cage has no comfortable chair. That may be deliberate; fellows grow expensive if allowed to settle. I left with two copies, one for the exhibition and one for Art. I was more frightened of the second conversation.

IF MURDERER

I examined the bowl early and compared my notes at the gallery table before the toast. I had two copies of the routing file and no tactful way to present either. Grant had seen the exhibition correction already. Art had not seen the one concerning his article. I kept revising the first sentence.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Reed DeLabel

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Reed DeLabel

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I copied restricted pages and hid them in my fellowship notebook. The green tabs divide the shipping chain from the published inference. Art had not seen the second section. If you combine them, keep the dates with the correct transfer. Grant wanted the notebook surrendered before the announcement, and I had quietly made a second copy.

IF MURDERER

My notebook contains restricted pages copied without permission. The green tabs divide the shipping chain from Art's inference. Grant demanded the notebook before his speech. I kept it in my bag and said the originals were elsewhere. I had made a second copy. I was preparing to lose my funding without losing the document.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Reed DeLabel

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed a correction from my supervisor and copied pages I should have requested properly. The research-cage log and interior film keep me with the green-tab file while the coupe was exposed. I feared losing the fellowship. I intend to present the research anyway. I did not poison its principal obstacle.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I worked at the outer table, with no research-cage stay to account for me. I took the stolen sample on the sleeve cloth and wiped Grant's empty coupe. He could erase my fellowship with a phone call. I made sure he would never place it. The archival discovery is real; the justification I built around it is mine.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.